Budget Justification

This proposal requests the standard Mathematical Sciences Postdoctoral Research Fellowship award of $190,000, as pre-populated in Research.gov according to NSF 23-603. The award is paid directly to the Fellow and consists of a stipend and a fellowship allowance. The PI has chosen the Research Fellowship option, to be held in the Department of Mathematics at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) with sponsoring scientist Davesh Maulik. No other funds are requested, and the proposal includes no cost sharing.

Stipend

The stipend of $5,833 per month ($70,000 per year of full-time support) covers 24 months: eighteen academic-year months, in intervals of at least three consecutive months within a three-year period, and three two-month summer periods. During these months the PI will work full time on the research described in the Project Description, with no teaching duties.

Fellowship allowance

The allowance of $50,000, paid as $30,000 in the first fellowship year and $20,000 in the second, will cover research expenses and fringe benefits, as provided in NSF 23-603:

- *Fringe benefits:* health, dental, and vision insurance, through a group plan offered by MIT or an individual plan, and retirement savings.
- *Relocation:* moving expenses from Chicago to Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- *Travel:* conferences and workshops in Hodge theory, hyper-Kähler geometry, and Hitchin systems, where the PI will present the results of the project, and short research visits to other institutions.
- *Research materials:* a laptop computer, books, and publication expenses.